They organised a demonstration and Erich marched in the parade to Neunkirchen, with the group from the Communist Youth League, to take part in it. They sneaked past the police guards and joined in the strikers' demonstration. As it was beginning, the local police were incited to attack the workers. The children immediately moved to the front, and the police fell back. Some of them, however, were getting ready to attack the children. Then the women and the workers surged forward and pushed the police back, and the demonstration began.

[4]

Honecker later mused:

Thinking back to those days, I must say that the Pioneer organisation can be enormously effective in developing class consciousness in young people. What you absorb at that age may not have much ideological basis, but it makes such a deep impression that you never forget it. At least that's the way it was with me.

Along with his siblings Willi, Frieda and Gertrud, he became an enthusiastic member of the Young Spartacus League – a small, but vocal communist youth group made up of around fifty boys and girls, designed to awaken class consciousness, promote education for the proletariat and to continue the 'struggle against the exploiters'. Kids were encouraged to stage dramatic productions such as 'Spartacus – the slave liberator' – sometimes; afternoon rehearsals of songs and marches took place in the Honeckers' attic.